

Step 1: Download the Linux ISO

First, you need to get the official disk image (ISO file) for the Linux distribution.

1. Go to the official Ubuntu website (ubuntu.com/download/desktop).
2. Click the green "Download" button next to the latest LTS version (Long Term Support).
3. Your browser will start downloading a file that ends in .iso (e.g., ubuntu-24.04-desktop-amd64.iso). This file is usually around 4 GB, so it might take a few minutes.

Step 2: Download Rufus

Rufus is a lightweight, free Windows utility that converts a normal USB flash drive into an installer.

1. Head to the official Rufus website (rufus.ie).
2. Scroll down to the *Download* section.
3. Click on the latest link (e.g., Rufus 4.5 Standard) to download the small .exe file. It runs instantly without needing a traditional setup installation.

Step 3: Flash the ISO to Your USB Drive

 **Warning:** This process will completely wipe everything currently saved on your USB flash drive. Make sure you back up any important files before proceeding!

1. Plug an empty USB flash drive (minimum 8 GB) into your computer.
2. Launch the downloaded Rufus file. Click "Yes" if Windows asks for permission to run it.
3. Configure the Rufus interface exactly like this:
 - **Device:** Click the dropdown and select your plugged-in USB drive.
 - **Boot selection:** Click the SELECT button on the right, browse your computer, and open the Ubuntu .iso file you downloaded in Step 1.
 - **Partition scheme:** Leave it as GPT (standard for modern UEFI computers).
 - **Target system:** Leave it as UEFI (non CSM).
4. Click the START button at the very bottom.
5. If a prompt appears asking to download additional files (like Syslinux or Grub), click Yes.
6. If a "ISOHybrid image detected" box pops up, select the recommended Write in ISO Image mode and click OK.

7. Confirm the final warning that all data will be destroyed by clicking OK.

Step 4: Complete the Flashing Process

Rufus will now format your drive, extract the Linux OS files, and make the drive bootable.

- You will see the green progress bar at the bottom fill up.
- Once the bar turns completely solid green and the text inside reads **READY**, your bootable USB is complete!

You can now close Rufus, leave the USB plugged in, and restart your computer while mashing your system's boot menu key (usually F12, F2, or Del) to boot directly into the Ubuntu installer.